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- This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

For each of the following techniques for resolving conflict:

1. Describe the technique.
2. Give TWO examples of the technique when used for conflict resolution.
3. Identify when each technique would be appropriate to use.

- Mediation
- Negotiation
- Counselling

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



What is the Conflict Process? - Definition and Stages

Lesson Transcript

The conflict process deals with five steps that help alleviate disagreement, problems or fighting within organizations. The five steps are potential opposition or incompatibility, cognition and personalization, intentions, behavior and outcomes.

Conflict Process

Violet Jones has been the manager of Intestinal Distress Taco for two years. Violet has dealt with many different employee issues, but lately there has been a problem that is really causing her concern. One of her most veteran employees is sabotaging sales. Eric brings constant negativity to the job and has actually made customers leave the restaurant.

Violet has a big conflict on her hands and will have to decide how and when she will move through a conflict process to solve the problem with Eric. A **conflict process** deals with five steps that help alleviate friction, disagreement, problems or fighting. The five steps are:

- **potential opposition or incompatibility**
- **cognition and personalization**
- **intentions**
- **behavior**
- **outcomes**

Let's take a look at Violet's situation with Eric to see how she utilizes the conflict process to solve her organizational issue.

Potential Opposition

The first stage of the conflict process is called **potential opposition or incompatibility**. In this stage, there are potential areas of conflict that could develop, and they consist of communication, structure and personal variables. For Violet, all three areas of incompatibility exist, so it's not surprising that she has multiple issues with Eric.

Eric does not listen very well and always misinterprets what Violet says during her daily meetings. For example, she might say that employees have to be friendlier to customers, but Eric takes that to mean that it is okay for him to talk to them about problems with the store and his personal life. The structure of the store is also a cause of conflict because Violet has over 25 employees to manage weekly. She does not have the time to follow Eric around and ensure that

he does not upset customers. In addition, Eric's personal variables lean towards conflict. He enjoys drama and is always ready to complain or fight with Violet over hours, tasks or customer service. The next step deals with the recognition of the fact that there is a conflict.

Cognition and Personalization

When one of the factors mentioned in the potential opposition stage actually materializes as a conflict, then stage two occurs based on **cognition and personalization**. During this stage, the perception of conflict arises between the parties. For example, Violet realized that Eric's numerous issues have caused a drop in sales of 15%. She is cognizant of the fact that Eric is the one responsible and that she needs to fix this issue. In order for personalization to occur, the parties must feel that there is conflict via stress, anger or frustration, resulting in emotional involvement. Once conflict arises, individuals must make a decision on how to handle the problem.

Intentions

The third stage is regarding **intentions**, or decisions to take action in a certain way. Violet does have a multitude of choices in how she can handle the conflict.

Violet can use competing, collaborating, avoiding, accommodating or compromising to solve the conflict with Eric. If she decides to be **competitive**, she only cares about winning and is not open to any compromise. She could involve Eric in trying to see if they can mutually come to a resolution using a **collaborative** or **compromising** style. She cannot take an **avoidance** stance and wish that the conflict would just disappear; she has lost too much money and continues to do so on a weekly basis. Lastly, Violet will not just give in and be **accommodating** to Eric.

She feels that she will try to compromise and collaborate with him in a Friday meeting offsite. She wants to know why he is being so negative and hurting business when he used to be a good worker. The meeting starts off very confrontational.

Behavior

The fourth stage is all about **behavior**, or where the conflicts become visible through yelling, fighting or crying. This is usually the most difficult stage because major issues have to be resolved. Strikes and wars would be an extreme example of this stage.

Violet's fourth stage started out with Eric being very angry about her accusations regarding his work behavior. After both of them calmed down, Eric ended up sobbing and revealing that he had just lost his pet dog of 10 years. He felt that there was nothing to live for and that life was full of sadness. His negative personal view melted into his work mood as well.

Fortunately, Violet was a pet owner and was able to relate to Eric's sadness. She confided in him about her own pet loss last year. She told him how she got through it and even gave him the name of an animal shelter where she found her newest pet. Violet felt that there was a positive outcome to the conflict. Eric promised to improve and Violet explained that she would put him on probation and not fire him - for now!

Outcomes

Outcomes is the last stage of the conflict process. The outcome is the final result of the conflict and can be classified as **functional** or **dysfunctional**. In Violet's case, it was a **functional outcome**, as the situation was resolved in a positive manner with the conflict resolved.

A **dysfunctional outcome** would be when the conflict causes even more negative results. For instance, if Violet's example with Eric went the wrong way, it could have resulted in Eric vandalizing the restaurant, quitting and writing bad online reviews. Eric would no longer be employed, but Violet would have other issues to deal with. Conflict resolution depends on the personalities of those involved. Educated, compassionate individuals with excellent communication skills can vastly improve the final outcome.

Lesson Summary

The **conflict process** deals with the five steps that help alleviate friction, disagreement, problems or fighting within organizations. The five steps are **potential opposition or incompatibility, cognition and personalization, intentions, behavior** and **outcomes**. Companies need to be able to quickly move through the conflict process professionally and eliminate any issues within their corporation.

Learning Outcome

After finishing this lesson, you should be able to:

- Recognize the steps of conflict resolution starting with potential opposition or incompatibility
- Remember cognition and personalization or knowing there is conflict and knowing what the cause is
- Recall intentions or how to handle things
- See behavior as the visibility of the conflict
- Find conflict outcome as either functional (solved) or dysfunctional (work still to do)



Harlow's Monkeys: Experiment, Comfort & Socialization

Lesson Transcript

What happens when you make a baby monkey choose between food and comfort? The Harlows answered this question in a series of primate experiments. Love is important, so how will these lonely monkeys function without it?

Introduction

Though the Beatles confidently tell us that 'all you need is love,' behavioral psychologists were skeptical that people and animals need--or are motivated by--anything other than food, water, shelter and sex. Psychologists **Harry and Margaret Harlow** decided to determine scientifically whether **love** is something we really need or just a feeling that we have toward things that satisfy our more basic, concrete, physical needs.

Harlow's Monkey Experiment

Harry Harlow founded a primate lab and started studying how infant monkeys developed when separated at birth from their mothers. He put these lonely monkeys in cages with two dolls. One was made out of wire with a wooden head and contained a bottle for the monkey's nourishment. The other was made of soft foam and covered in cuddly cloth but did not have a bottle. With this setup, Harlow attempted to separate the two things the monkey gets from its mother: nourishment and comfort. The **wire mother** gave food, while the **cloth mother** gave warmth and comfort.

Preference For Warmth And Comfort

The prevailing behaviorist theories of the time would predict that the lonely monkey would quickly grow attached to the wire mother, since it dispensed the food. But Harlow was surprised to observe that the monkeys spent an overwhelming amount of time with the cloth mother, moving to the wire mother only when they needed to eat. Their affection for the cloth mother had nothing to do with food and everything to do with **warmth** and **comfort**.

Relationship Between Comfort and Security

To further test the monkeys' attachment to the cloth mother, Harlow decided to scare them to see how they'd react. He created an ugly, scary paper monster to surprise and frighten them. When the monster appeared, the monkeys screeched and cried and ran immediately to the cloth mother for comfort and **security**. For all measurable purposes, the baby monkeys seemed

to love the cloth mother and interact with it in the same way they'd interact with a real mother. Harlow concluded that the need for **love** has nothing physically to do with **survival**--the cloth mother didn't give the monkey anything it physically needed--but is nevertheless important.

Need for Socialization

Not surprisingly, the cloth mother proved a poor substitute for a real mother. Harlow found that only baby monkeys who were raised with their **real mothers** and other **monkey playmates** developed into happy, **secure adults**. Babies raised by a real mother and without playmates became more **fearful** and **aggressive**, and those initially raised by the cloth and wire mothers had trouble learning to socialize with other monkeys when they returned to communal cages. But the monkeys who were raised by the dolls and had no contact with other monkeys fared the worst; they developed social impairments that affected them the rest of their lives. The cloth mothers provided an outlet for the monkeys' need for comfort, but not for socialization, which emerged as equally important for normal development.

Summary

Harlow's research had far-reaching consequences. He disrupted the prevailing mindset that love was based purely on physical needs; he showed that love and comfort were non-physical needs that nevertheless were important to normal development. But the cruelty of the experiment also drew attention and led to reforms in regulations about how lab animals were treated. Subjecting infant monkeys to total isolation impaired them for life; such an experiment would be considered an ethical violation by today's standards.

Lesson Objectives

Once you complete this lesson you'll be able to:

- Explain the findings of Harlow's monkey experiment
- Understand why the monkey's ran to the cloth mother when frightened
- Comprehend the monkey's need for both comfort and socialization
- Consider the relationship between safety and comfort
- Explain why monkey's raised without playmates became fearful and aggressive



Internal Working Model: Definition & Explanation

Lesson Transcript

From the relationship with your parents and caregivers, you learn how to love, hate, trust, treat strangers, and anticipate outcomes to various situations. This concept is called internal working model and is a key aspect of Bowlby's attachment theory.

Internal Working Model & Attachment Theory

You're walking down the street and make eye contact with a stranger; you smile because that's how you learned to respond to people. You anticipate two responses from that person: They either smile back, or ignore you. How did you know that? Have you ever wondered how you learned about other people and the world? More importantly, have you ever considered how you learned about yourself in reference to others and the world?

One approach to these questions is the internal working model and how it relates to the parent-child relationship - attachment. We're going to discuss how the internal working model is a key factor of Bowlby's attachment theory and why the parent-child attachment is crucial for healthy development.

Attachment Theory

To start, let's take a look at the theory closely associated with internal working model: attachment theory. John Bowlby was a prominent psychologist who believed that the parent-child relationship was the foundation for social relationships and sense of self; the interactions the infant has with their parent or primary caregiver helps them learn about themselves, others, and the world.

This belief is the source of Bowlby's **attachment theory**, the idea that the attachment, or emotional bond, formed between an infant and parent/caregiver help the child learn about the world and how to interact in it. There are four types of attachment: secure, insecure ambivalent, insecure avoidant, and disorganized.

Internal Working Model

A key factor of attachment theory is the **internal working model**. The **internal working model** can be defined as a thinking process, which is built on past experiences and helps the individual consider responses and actions.

As infants interact with their caregivers and the world, they begin to internalize those experiences and form schema, or thoughts; the more experiences, the more thoughts are created and built upon. Think of schema as Lego blocks; the more pieces you collect, the larger the structure you can build.

The best part of the internal working model is that it serves as reference center; as you encounter new situations, you can refer back to your past to learn from and make decisions about current and future responses.

Developmental Impact

The internal working model particularly reflects the social schema related to sense of self, interactions with other people, and how the world works. As the child develops, this internal working model continues to evolve and move from basic experiences to abstract thought, which includes anticipation and prediction.

A child with a secure attachment will have an internal working model that reflects a high level of self-worth ('My mother responds to me when I need her, I must be worthy of love.'), trust in other people ('When I am in need, my father is there.'), and belief that the world is safe. Why are these positive reflections important? This serves as a security blanket for children as they continue to explore their environment.

For children who are unfortunate to have parents/caregivers that are not responsive to their needs or supportive, the attachment can be negative; this can result in an internal working model that reflects distrust in the world and other people, as well as a negative view of self. This negativity can lead to hostility, feelings of inferiority, and other psychological issues, such as anxiety and depression.

Lesson Summary

While most people will agree that a healthy parent-child relationship is crucial early in the child's life, many may not know why. The **attachment theory** states the attachment or emotional bond a child forms with a parent or caregiver, creates thoughts and launches the cognitive processes that help them learn. Through these experiences, we develop an **internal working model** that serves as a guide as to how we view ourselves, relate and connect to other people, and interact with the world.

Ψ
HARLOW

ATTACHMENT in MONKEYS (Fig 14.6 p.199 text)

AIM

SAMPLE

IV (experimental vs control condition)

DV

OPERATIONAL HYPOTHESIS

RESULTS

CONCLUSION

GENERALISATION



Attachment Theory: Definition & Criticism of Bowlby & Ainsworth's Theories

Lesson Transcript

Relationships are built between two people. These meaningful bonds are critical for human development, and the most important type of relationship is that between child and parent or caregiver. This lesson will discuss attachment theory and the role of attachment on human growth and development.

Relationships and Attachment

Relationships occur between humans every day throughout the world. Adults build relationships with friends that may turn into romantic relationships. Peers develop relationships with each other, which may lead to close friendships, and children build relationships with their parents or caregivers. It is this type of relationship between parent and child that this lesson will focus on.

All types of relationships, whether romantic, friendly, or parental, are important for human development. The most critical of these types, however, is that between the parent and child. Many theorists, including Freud and Erikson, emphasized the importance of a stable parent-child relationship in order for normal development to occur.

A British psychiatrist, John Bowlby, developed a theory around these parent-child relationships called **attachment theory**.

Attachment Theory Foundations

Attachment theory is based primarily on ethological theory, or how animals behave; evolutionary theory, or how humans evolve; and psychoanalytic theory, which is the theory that human behavior is driven by unconscious urges and instinctual biological drives.

According to Bowlby, **attachment** is defined as a strong emotional tie that bonds one person intimately with another person. Attachment is also a behavior system through which humans regulate emotional distress, such as being threatened. Behaviors which draw humans to security in threatening situations underlie attachment theory. Let us try to understand this through an attachment scenario.

A baby forms an attachment with his or her parent at birth. This attachment develops over time, and by around six to seven months, a strong bond is formed. We know this attachment has occurred because the child tries to maintain proximity to the parent, may follow the parent

around, saves the biggest smiles for the parent, becomes upset when the parent is gone, and seeks the parent when he or she feels threatened or scared.

This scenario illustrates how attachment theory draws from ethological theory and research. Biological predispositions and tendencies, such as babies staying close to their mothers in the wild for protection, have contributed to human survival. This form of imprinting, or learning in which a baby animal follows and becomes attached to the first moving object it encounters (usually the mother), is critical during the early part of life and establishes the groundwork for attachment.

Bowlby points out that young children may not become imprinted to their mothers, but they will definitely follow loved ones around. Young children also engage in other behaviors that ensure their caregiver or parent will love them, stay close, and meet their safety needs, such as smiling, cooing, crying, and babbling.

Attachment Theory Elaborated

American developmental psychologist Mary Ainsworth elaborated on Bowlby's work through her own experiments, such as the Strange Situation Protocol, in which she explored anxieties and identified types of attachment. This research and the types of parent-child attachment Ainsworth found are discussed in another lesson.

According to Bowlby, there is a sensitive period for attachment to occur, and that is within the first three years of life. Attachments are not automatic either. In order for an attachment to occur, there must be a reciprocal interaction between parent and child. If a caregiver is unresponsive to the child's attempts for affection or cries, the child may become unresponsive to that caregiver's presence.

Internal Working Models of Attachment

The early attachment between parent and child creates an **internal working model** of how social relationships and behaviors in relationships typically operate. These internal working models guide subsequent relationships between peers and romantic relationships in adult life.

Securely-attached infants who have received attention, care, and responsiveness from caregivers will develop internal working models that suggest they are lovable and that others can be trusted to care for them.

However, insecurely-attached infants who receive little attention or are abused will develop internal working models that suggest people can't be trusted and that they are difficult to love. These types of working models can cause problems in later relationships, such as jealousy, overdependence, or shying away from relationships altogether. An insecure attachment in a child doesn't necessarily persist through that child's life because other relationships can have different attachment patterns later on.

Summary

In summary, **attachment theory** was developed by Bowlby and elaborated by Ainsworth and is based on ethological, evolutionary, and psychoanalytical theories and research. These researchers indicated that attachments unfold through an interaction of biological and environmental forces during a sensitive period early in life, within the first three years.

The first attachment relationship, the one between infant and parent or caregiver, shapes later development and the quality of later relationships. Finally, **internal working models** of self and others, formed via early-life attachments, provide the foundation for relationships through one's lifetime.

Learning Outcome

The lesson above should make it easier for you to:

- Explain the foundations of attachment theory
- Define attachment and understand its functions
- Describe the importance of the bond between child and parent and how the strength of attachment during infancy can affect other types of relationships throughout a person's life
- Understand what is needed for a parent-child attachment to occur

Ψ
BOWLBY

ATTACHMENT in HUMANS
Maternal Deprivation Hypothesis
(p. 199 – 200)

1. What is the “sensitive period” referred to by Bowlby?
2. Define “imprinting”
3. What is the underlying idea of Bowlby’s hypothesis?
4. According to Bowlby, what is the main outcome of a child not experiencing a warm & reciprocal relationship with their mother?
5. Describe the importance of the “primary bond” in Bowlby’s hypothesis.
6. Define “monotropy”.
7. Describe what is meant by “signaling behaviours” by the child and provide 3 examples.
8. What is the critical period for mothers forming an attachment with their child.
9. Define “maternal deprivation” & describe the consequences for the child of maternal deprivation.
10. Bowlby refers to the “internal working model”. Define & describe this model.



The Strange Situation Test: Ainsworth's Attachment Theory for Infants

Lesson Transcript

The attachment and bonds infants develop early in life play a critical role in their interactions with others as they grow. This lesson will introduce the Strange Situation experiment conducted by Mary Ainsworth and discuss the four infant attachment types identified through the experiment.

Infant and Child Anxiety

Have you ever approached an infant or young child of a colleague or friend that you have never met? Did that child appear apprehensive and anxious? Perhaps the child even hid behind the leg of his or her parent or cried when you approached. This behavior is very typical and expected among infants and young children.

The psychologist Mary Ainsworth explained this behavior through an attachment theory.

Attachment is defined as a deep and long-term bond that connects one person to another. Ainsworth and her colleagues conducted an experiment to assess the security of attachment in infants and young children. This experiment sought to observe separation and stranger anxiety and also determine the different types of attachment styles exhibited between children and their primary caregiver.

Separation anxiety is the stage in which a child experiences anxiety, such as fretfulness and wariness, when separated from the primary caregiver. Separation anxiety typically appears when infants are forming attachments around 8 months of age and peaks at approximately 14-18 months of age. Over time, this type of anxiety becomes less frequent and less intense, especially when children feel safe in their home environment and trust that the caregiver will return. In extreme cases, separation anxiety can cause a child to refuse to go to school or other places for fear of separation and refuse to go to sleep without the caregiver being nearby.

Stranger anxiety is the reaction to a stranger that may cause a child to become quiet, wary of the person, or hide. Stranger anxiety is common among children between the ages of 8-18 months. Stranger anxiety typically declines as the child approaches the age of 2 years old.

The Strange Situation Experiment

The Strange Situation experimental procedure was developed by Ainsworth and her colleagues in the 1970s. The procedure was developed in order to measure the quality of infant attachments in 1-2 year olds. The experiment sample consisted of approximately 100 middle-class American families.

The procedure consists of 8 separate yet continual episodes that gradually escalate the amount of stress infants experience as they react to the approach of an adult stranger and the departure and return of their caregiver. Through these episodes, the researchers identified 4 types of infant attachment: secure, resistant, avoidant, and disorganized-disoriented, which we will discuss in detail later in this lesson.

The Strange Situation proceeded as follows:

- Episode 1: An experimenter leaves the parent or caregiver and baby alone to play.
- Episode 2: The parent sits while the baby plays. Researchers observed the use of the parent as a secure base in this episode.
- Episode 3: A stranger enters the room and talks to the parent. Researchers observed stranger anxiety in this episode.
- Episode 4: The parent leaves the room and the stranger stays, letting the baby play and offering comfort if necessary. Researchers observed separation anxiety in this episode.
- Episode 5: The parent returns, greets the baby, and offers comfort if needed, and the stranger leaves the room. Researchers observed the reactions to reunion during this episode.
- Episode 6: The parent leaves the room again. Only the baby is in the room. Researchers are again observing separation anxiety.
- Episode 7: The stranger enters the room and offers comfort to the baby. Researchers are observing stranger anxiety and the ability of the baby to be soothed by a stranger.
- Episode 8: The parent returns to the room, greets the baby, and offers comfort. The baby is allowed to return to play. Researchers observed the reactions to reunion in this final episode.

Attachment Types

Secure Attachment

Ainsworth and colleagues identified 4 types of infant attachment through observations of the Strange Situation: secure, resistant, avoidant, and disorganized-disoriented.

The most common type of attachment is labeled as **secure attachment**. Approximately 60-65% of infants and young children in our society are labeled as securely attached to their parents or primary caregivers.

The securely attached infant actively plays and explores the room when his parent is in the room because he or she serves as a secure base. The infant may be upset when the parent leaves but greets his parent happily and is comforted by the parent's presence when he or she returns. The securely-attached child is friendly and outgoing with strangers when the parent is present.

Resistant Attachment

Another type of attachment is **resistant attachment**. Approximately 10% infants and young children show a resistant attachment. This is observed as an insecure attachment characterized by anxious, ambivalent reactions. The child that is characterized with this type of attachment

does not explore and play, even when his parent is in the room. The parent appears to not serve as a secure base for exploration and play.

The child does, however, become upset when the parent leaves, sometimes showing higher levels of separation anxiety than a securely-attached child. When the parent returns to the room, the child is unsure and hesitant. He may try to get close to the parent but also seems to be resentful for the parent leaving in the first place. The child may resist attempts by the parent to comfort and soothe and is also wary of strangers, even in the presence of the parent.

Avoidant Attachment

Researchers also observed **avoidant attachment**. Children characterized as avoidant attachment, which is up to 15% of children, seem uninterested in exploring, show little distress when separated from their mothers or parents, and avoid contact when their parent returns. The avoidant-attached child is not very wary of strangers but may avoid or even ignore them, similar to how they avoid or ignore their parents. Avoidant children seem to have distanced themselves from their parents, almost as if saying, 'I don't need your affection.'

Disorganized-Disoriented

The final attachment type identified by researchers is **disorganized-disoriented attachment**. Up to 15% of children are characterized as this level of attachment. Most of these children come from high-risk homes (with little continual care or little attention). When these children are reunited with their parents after a separation period, they may act surprised or even lie on the floor immobilized. Sometimes they try to make contact with the parent, but then they will quickly retreat. These children seem to be confused and unable to approach or avoid the parent. They may become distressed in the presence of strangers but are unable to seek proper comfort because they also view the parent warily.

Lesson Summary

Mary Ainsworth, a psychologist, and her colleagues developed an experiment, known as **the Strange Situation**, in order to explore and identify attachment types among infants and young children. During these experiments, researchers observed child, parent, and stranger interactions in order to determine levels of **attachment**, **separation anxiety**, and **stranger anxiety**. Researchers identified four types of attachment styles.

Secure infants, which make up the majority of all infants and young children, play and explore freely when the parent is near. They are upset when separated from the parent but easily comforted when they return. They are also friendly and outgoing with strangers when the parent is near.

Resistant infants, 10% of the population, explore and play minimally. They are upset at the parent's departure but hesitant to seek comfort when the parent returns. They are also wary of strangers.

The **avoidant** infant, 15% of the population, seems to be uninterested in exploration or play. They exhibit little distress when the parent leaves and avoid contact when the parent returns. They also avoid or ignore strangers in a similar fashion.

Finally, the **disorganized-disoriented** infant, up to 15% of the population, exhibits behaviors of confusion or surprise when the parent returns from separation. They may simply freeze in their actions. They are also wary of strangers.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the video, you will be able to:

- Describe the experiment used to test the security of attachment in infants and young children
- List the attachment types
- Understand the most common attachment types and the least common

AINSWORTH

THE STRANGE SITUATION

<https://www.simplypsychology.org/mary-ainsworth.html>

Main differences between Bowlby and Ainsworth

- Bowlby describes attachment as an “all or nothing” concept; Ainsworth describes individual differences in attachment quality.
 - Ainsworth developed an experimental procedure, Bowlby did not.
-

PROCEDURE:

Summarise the Strange Situation under the following headings

SAMPLE:

METHOD:

STAGE	DESCRIPTION of ACTIVITY
1 & 2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	

OBSERVATIONS RECORDED:

- (i)
- (ii)
- (iii)
- (iv)
- (v)
- (vi)

(vii)

RESULTS:

	Secure attachment (Type B)	Insecure avoidant attachment (Type A)	Insecure ambivalent/ resistant attachment (Type C)
<i>Separation anxiety</i>			
<i>Stranger anxiety</i>			
<i>Reunion behaviour</i>			
<i>Other</i>			
% infants			

CONCLUSIONS:

A FOURTH ATTACHMENT TYPE:

Disorganized/Disoriented Attachment: TYPE D
(NEW!!)

Emerged after further studies were done after Ainsworth's initial 1970 study. The behaviour of disorganised attached children is inconsistent. This child might be distressed when the mother leaves the room and be relieved when she comes back. However, the child may not want to be held or may show anger once the mother approaches.

Further research revealed that more than half of the mothers with a child who fell into this category had suffered a trauma immediately before the birth of the child and had developed depression because of that trauma.

LINKING BOWLBY & AINSWORTH

- Findings provided the first empirical evidence for Bowlby's attachment theory
- Securely attached children (Ainsworth) develop a positive internal working model (Bowlby)
- Insecure attachment types (Ainsworth) are associated with an increased risk of social and emotional behavioural problems via the internal working model.

CULTURAL VARIATIONS IN ATTACHMENT

STUDY	FINDINGS
Van IJzendoorn & Kroonenberg (1988)	
Sagi et al (1994)	
Grossman et al (1985)	
Durkin (1995)	



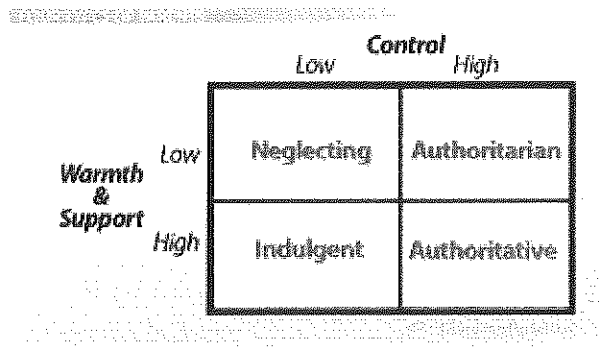
Impact of Parenting Styles on Different Styles of Learners

Lesson Transcript

When you got in trouble as a child, how did your parents react? This lesson covers four different parenting styles identified in educational psychology, including authoritarian, authoritative, indulgent, and neglecting. Typical results from each parenting style are discussed in terms of children's behaviors, as well as application of the styles in a classroom environment.

Parenting Style

Think back to when you were a little kid and you got in trouble. How did your parents react? Did they punish you? What kind of punishment was it? Did they calmly explain why your behavior was not okay? Or did they even pay attention at all? Maybe they let you do whatever you wanted and smothered you with love and attention, spoiling you!



Parenting styles are based on levels of control as well as warmth and support

This lesson focuses on different types of parents and how parenting styles affect children, both at home and in a classroom environment. As we talk about each style, try to relate that to your own experiences. Which style of parents did you have? If you have children, which style do you think will fit you as a parent yourself?

Four Types of Parents

Different parenting styles have been studied by child psychologists for many years but really got attention in the 1970s and 80s. There have been a few psychologists who have come up with names and theories for different parenting styles, but in general, psychologists have agreed on four basic styles of parenting. For each of the four styles, we can plot the style along two basic dimensions, which are level of control from the parents (either high or low) and level of warmth and support from the parents (again, either high or low).

Authoritarian

The first style is called **authoritarian**. Authoritarian parents are extremely strict, controlling, demanding, and unforgiving. If you think about our two basic parenting dimensions, authoritarian parents are high on control and low on warmth and support. Let's think of an example. Imagine John breaks a simple rule at home, such as coming home 30 minutes after curfew one night. Authoritarian parents will give the child a swift and severe punishment without even trying to listen for John's explanation for being late. In a single word, the best description for authoritarian parents might be 'obedience.' In extreme cases, authoritarian parents might even become abusive. Children of authoritarian parents tend to have low self-esteem and make moral decisions based on rules instead of on internalized beliefs about what is right and wrong.



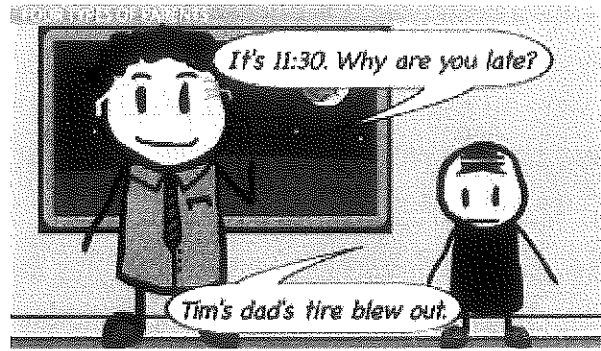
Children of authoritarian parents are more likely to have low self-esteem

Authoritative

The second parenting style is called **authoritative**. Authoritative parents are high on control and rules but also high in warmth and support. So, when we graph our two dimensions, authoritative parents fall here. If John came home late for curfew, authoritative parents would be waiting up, ready to punish him if there's no good excuse. However, they would also be willing to listen to an explanation and be understanding if there was a good reason for being late, such as a flat tire in the car. While authoritarian parents (the first style we covered) might display mostly anger when a child breaks the rules, authoritative parents might instead display concern or disappointment. Most psychologists believe that the children of authoritative parents have the highest self-esteem, success with peers, and do well in academic and professional settings. So, basically, many psychologists believe that authoritative parenting is the best style for most kids.

Indulgent

The third parenting style is called **indulgent**, or sometimes **permissive**. These parents fail to set any standards for behavior, are tolerant of all behaviors, and give in to their child's desires. In other words, these parents are low in the control dimension but high in the warmth and support dimension. They let their kids do whatever they want, such as eat ice cream and cookies for dinner or go to bed at 2:00 am after watching scary movies all night. If we think about our example of John coming home late, we can't even imagine what his parents might do because they never would have set a curfew in the first place! Children with indulgent parents tend to be aggressive, impulsive, and selfish.



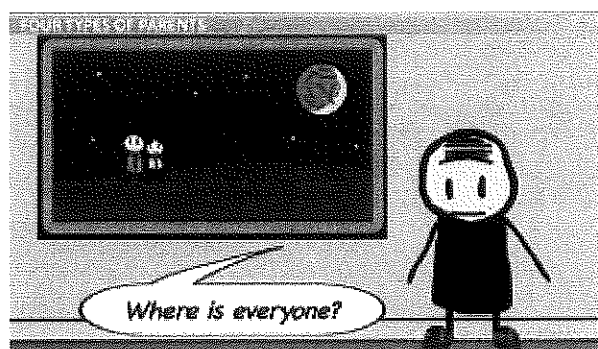
Authoritative parents are willing to consider input from their children

Neglecting

The fourth and final parenting style identified by psychologists is called **neglecting**. Neglecting parents are not involved in either control or love; they are basically absent. In other words, neglecting parents are either literally not at home or simply don't give their children any attention at all, either good or bad. These parents are thus low in both of our parenting dimensions. Children with neglecting parents are sometimes very aggressive in showing negative behaviors. It could be that these kids are simply looking for any attention they can get. Or, sometimes, children with neglecting parents end up being very independent, but they typically have low levels of trust for other people in general. To finish up our example with John coming home late for curfew, his parents might not even be home to notice when he arrives, and if they were home, they wouldn't care what time it was because they would be busy doing other things.

Classroom Application

Now that you know all four types of parenting, you can probably see how children from different types of home and family situations might act differently when they get to school. If a child comes from a family where the parents are very strict in terms of rules, the child will probably follow the rules better at school. However, if a child isn't getting enough attention at home, that child might act out in negative ways at school to get attention from the teacher or from peers. Teachers should consider each student's home life as a background for why their students act in different ways as a path to understand each child's needs and motivations.



Children of neglectful parents tend to be less trusting of others

In addition, you can see how these four types of parenting styles could also apply to different styles of teaching. Did you have some teachers who were extremely controlling and who would not listen to explanations for why an assignment might be turned in late? Or did you have other teachers who didn't really seem to care what was happening in their classroom, and the students could do whatever they wanted to do?

Educational psychologists have studied how these different styles in both parents and in teachers might combine to give children either the structure and love they need or how they might be lacking in providing the best possible environment for children. When you think about your own parents and teachers, do you think you received the best possible combination of control and loving support?

Summary

In summary, educational psychologists have identified four basic parenting styles, which vary on two dimensions. The dimensions are level of control versus level of warmth and support. This graph shows both dimensions. The four styles are authoritarian, authoritative, indulgent, and neglecting. Each style results in different types of children. While these styles are usually discussed in terms of parenting, they can easily be applied to classrooms as each teacher might embody one of these styles. What kind of parents and teachers did you have?

Lesson Objectives

After watching this lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify the four parenting styles and characteristics of each
- Interpret child behaviors from each in terms of classroom application

Types of Parenting Styles and How to Identify Yours

Posted on December 10, 2013 by Emily Hughes

By Bianca Mgbemere and Rachel Telles

In psychology today, there are four major recognized parenting styles: authoritative, neglectful, permissive, and authoritarian. Each one carries different characteristics and brings about different reactions in the children which they are used on. It is important to keep in mind that every parent child relationship is different, so there is not one sure fire way to go about parenting. This is a simple guide to help decode your parenting style and provide general suggestions on how to raise a happy, responsible, productive member of society.

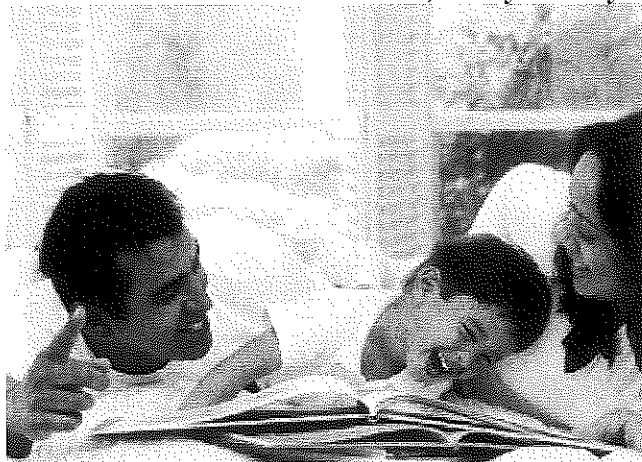
Authoritative

Authoritative parenting is widely regarded as the most effective and beneficial parenting style for normal children. Authoritative parents are easy to recognize, as they are marked by the high expectations that they have of their children, but temper these expectations with understanding a support for their children as well. This type of parenting creates the healthiest environment for a growing child, and helps to foster a productive relationship between parent and child.

How to recognize if you are an authoritative parent:

- ☐ Does your child's day have structure to it, such as a planned bedtime and understood household rules?
- ☐ Are there consequences for disrupting this structure or breaking the household rules?
- ☐ Does your child understand the expectations that you have for their behavior, and are these expectations reasonable?
- ☐ Do you have a healthy and open line of communication with your child? That is, does your child feel that they can speak to you about anything without fear of negative consequence or harsh judgment?

The traits described in the above questions mark a healthy household with an authoritative parent. Of course, parenting styles will naturally need to differ in order to accommodate different children, and you may find that this style does not work for



you if your child has behavioral problems or other traits you have difficulty handling. In this case, it is best to adjust

your parenting appropriately, and to seek out help from a licensed therapist if you feel overwhelmed.

One of the most important traits to emulate in the authoritative parenting style is the open communication style with the child. If a parent can foster the ability to speak to their child without judgment or reprimand, they will be more likely to have insight into the child's life and understanding, providing the child with a deeper understanding of the world around them.

Neglectful

Neglectful parenting is one of the most harmful styles of parenting that can be used on a child. Neglectful parenting is unlike the other styles in that parents rarely fluctuate naturally into neglectful parenting as a response to child behavior. If a parent recognizes themselves as a neglectful parent, or if a friend recognizes that they may know a neglectful parent, it is important to understand that those parents (and the children involved in the situation) need assistance so that they can get back on track to having a healthy and communicative relationship within the family.

If you suspect you or a friend may be a neglectful parent, consider the following:

- ☐ Do you care for your child's needs—emotional, physical, and otherwise?
- ☐ Do you have an understanding of what is going on in your child's life?
- ☐ Does the home provide a safe space for the child where they can share their experiences and expect positive feedback rather than negative or no feedback?
- ☐ Do you spend long periods of time away from home, leaving the child alone?
- ☐ Do you often find yourself making excuses for not being there for your child?
- ☐ Do you know your child's friends? Teachers?
- ☐ Are you involved in your child's life outside the home?

If the above describe you or someone that you know, a child is at risk of being damaged by a neglectful household. Parents who tend towards neglectful parenting styles can be easily helped through education; this education can be found by talking

to the family doctor, or going to a therapist or counselor.



Neglectful parenting is damaging to children, because they have no trust foundation with their parents from which to explore the world. Beyond that, children who have a negative or absent relationship with their parent will have a harder time forming relationships with other people, particularly children their age. If you suspect that you or a friend of yours may be a neglectful parent, it is important to seek help in a way that does not damage the child further or intrude into their life in a disruptive manner.

Permissive

Permissive parenting, also known as indulgent parenting is another potentially harmful style of parenting. These parents are responsive but not demanding. These parents tend to be lenient while trying to avoid confrontation. The benefit of this parenting style is that they are usually very nurturing and loving. The negatives, however, outweigh this benefit. Few rules are set for the children of permissive parents, and the rules are inconsistent when they do exist. This lack of structure causes these children to grow up with little self-discipline and self-control. Some parents adopt this method as an extreme opposite approach to their authoritarian upbringing, while others are simply afraid to do anything that may upset their child.

How to recognize if you are a permissive parent:

- ☐ Do you not have set limits or rules for your child? Do you often compromise your rules to accommodate your child's mood?
- ☐ Do you avoid conflict with your child?
- ☐ Do you have a willingness to be your child's best friend rather than their parent?
- ☐ Do you often bribe your child to do things with large rewards?

The traits described in the above questions mark an unhealthy permissive parenting style. It may seem as though this would be a child's favorite parenting style as it provides a sense of freedom without consequences, however, children crave a sense of structure to make them feel safe and. It is important in a child's development for there to be clear cut parental and child roles. Permissive parenting can have long-term damaging effects. In a study published in the scientific *Journal of Early Adolescence*, it was found that teens with permissive parents are three times more likely to engage in heavy underage alcohol consumption. This is likely do to their lack of consequences for their behavior.

Other damaging effects of permissive parenting include:

- ☐ insecurity in children from of lack of set boundaries
- ☐ poor social skills, such as sharing, from lack of discipline
- ☐ self-centeredness
- ☐ poor academic success from lack of motivation
- ☐ clashing with authority

It is important for the permissive parent to begin to set boundaries and rules for their child, while still being responsive before it is too late. If enacting new structures proves too daunting, it is advised again to seek out the help of a licensed therapist.

Authoritarian

Authoritarian parenting, also called strict parenting, is characterized by parents who are demanding but not responsive. Authoritarian parents allow for little open dialogue between parent and child and expect children to follow a strict set of rules and expectations. They usually rely on punishment to demand obedience or teach a lesson.

Recognizing your authoritarian style:

- ☐ Do you have very strict rules that you believe should be followed no matter what?
- ☐ Do you often find yourself offering no explanations for the rules other than "Because I said so?"
- ☐ Do you give your child few choices and decisions about their own life?
- ☐ Do you find yourself utilizing punishment as a means of getting your child to do what you ask?
- ☐ Are you reserved in the amount of warmth and nurturing you show your child?

While the structure and rules of an authoritarian parent are necessary for healthy child development, all good things can be overdone. It is important to balance out the provided structure with open communication so the child knows exactly why it is important for them to follow the rules placed in front of them. Children of authoritarian parents are prone to having low self-esteem, being fearful or shy, associating obedience with love, having difficulty in social situations, and possibly misbehaving when outside of parental care. A therapist can once again be

contacted if adopting open communication proves to be too difficult to achieve by oneself.

Resources:

<http://www.webmd.com/parenting/features/too-permissive-parents?page=3>

http://www.the-positive-parenting-centre.com/permissive_parenting_style.html

<http://psychology.about.com/od/developmentalpsychology/a/parenting-style.htm>

<http://www.answers.com/topic/parent-child-relationships?cat=health>

Baumrind, D. (1991). The influence of parenting style on adolescent competence and substance use. *Journal of Early Adolescence*, 11(1), 56-95.

<http://psychology.about.com/od/childcare/f/authoritative-parenting.htm>

<http://cccrd.publishpath.com/Websites/cccrd/images/NParenting.pdf>

<https://www.childwelfare.gov/pubs/usermanuals/neglect/chapterthree.cfm>

<http://www.human.cornell.edu/pam/outreach/parenting/research/upload/Parenting-20Styles-20and-20Adolescents.pdf>

